

Password Reset & Account Recovery Guide

Version 3.2 | Support Team | support@example.com | Last Updated: January 2025

1. Overview

This guide covers the complete password reset and account recovery process. Follow these steps if you have forgotten your password, lost access to your registered email, or are locked out due to multiple failed login attempts.

2. Standard Password Reset (Email-Based)

Use this method if you still have access to your registered email address.

1. Go to app.example.com/login and click "Forgot Password?"
2. Enter your registered email address and click "Send Reset Link"
3. Check your inbox for an email from noreply@example.com (check spam if not received within 2 minutes)
4. Click the reset link - it is valid for 60 minutes only
5. Enter and confirm your new password (minimum 12 characters, must include uppercase, number, and symbol)
6. Click "Reset Password" - you will be automatically logged in
7. Recommended: Enable MFA immediately at Settings > Security > Two-Factor Authentication

Note: After a successful reset, all active sessions are automatically revoked for security.

3. Recovery When MFA Device is Lost

Option A: Use a Backup Code

1. On the MFA prompt screen, click "Use a backup code instead"
2. Enter one of the 10 backup codes provided during MFA setup
3. You will be logged in - immediately reconfigure MFA with your new device

Option B: Identity Verification (If Backup Codes Are Lost)

1. Email security@example.com from your registered email address
2. Subject: "MFA Recovery Request - [Your Account Email]"
3. Attach a government-issued photo ID (passport, national ID, or drivers license)
4. Our security team will verify and respond within 1 business day
5. You will receive a one-time recovery link valid for 30 minutes

4. Account Lockout After Failed Login Attempts

Your account is temporarily locked after 5 consecutive failed login attempts.

Lockout Condition	Resolution
15 min lock (5 attempts)	Wait for automatic unlock
60 min lock (10 attempts)	Click unlock link sent to email
24 hour lock (20 attempts)	Contact support@example.com
Permanent (suspicious activity)	Identity verification required

5. Recovery When Email Address is No Longer Accessible

If you no longer have access to your registered email address (e.g., former employer email):

- Email support@example.com from any email address you currently own
- Subject: "Account Recovery - Email Change Request - [Your Old Account Email]"
- Provide: full name, last 4 digits of payment method on file, organization name, approximate account creation date
- Our team will verify your identity and respond within 2 business days
- Once verified, we will transfer ownership to your new email address

6. Enterprise Account Recovery (SSO-Based Accounts)

Enterprise accounts using SSO must reset passwords through your organizations Identity Provider (IdP). Our platform cannot override SSO authentication.

Identity Provider	Recovery Path
Microsoft Azure AD / Entra ID	Contact IT helpdesk or use SSPR portal
Google Workspace	Contact your Google Workspace admin
Okta	Use self-service portal or contact Okta admin
OneLogin	Use OneLogin self-service password reset

For emergency Enterprise access: Call +1-800-555-0199 (24/7 support line).

7. Password Requirements

All passwords must meet these minimum security requirements:

- Minimum 12 characters in length
- At least one uppercase letter (A-Z)
- At least one lowercase letter (a-z)
- At least one number (0-9)
- At least one special character (!@#\$\$%^&*)
- Cannot be the same as your previous 10 passwords
- Cannot contain your email address or username

8. Quick Reference Table

Situation	Recommended Action
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Forgot password, have email access	Standard email reset (Section 2)
Lost MFA device, have backup codes	Use backup code (Section 3A)
Lost MFA device and backup codes	Email security@example.com (Section 3B)
Account locked after failed attempts	Wait or contact support (Section 4)
Lost access to account email	Identity verification (Section 5)
SSO / Enterprise account	Contact your IT admin (Section 6)
Emergency Enterprise access	Call +1-800-555-0199 (24/7)

9. Support Contact Directory

Channel	Contact	Response Time
General Support	support@example.com	24-48 hours (Pro)
Security & Recovery	security@example.com	Within 4 hours
Enterprise Hotline	+1-800-555-0199	24/7 Immediate
Status & Incidents	status.example.com	Real-time